Q. What inspired you to write this book?
I felt there is a big need for the youth to get guidance on how to live their life. We live in a world filled with distractions and entertainment, and it is very easy to lose focus. I felt another romance novel will be entertaining for sure but may not give what is truly needed for the younger generation of India. At the same time, I wanted to write a self-help book that is also fun and entertaining.

Q. Why do we need these rules?
We often live sub-optimal lives. Neither are we able to reach our potential in fitness, nor in our career. This happens because we don't have a directed way of living our life. These 11 rules, if followed, can give you a sense of purpose and direction in life. These rules worked for me, and now I hope they will work for my readers too.

Q. In the 'Introduction', you highlight the importance of reading. Why are we losing the reading habit?
We are losing the habit because it is far easier and pleasurable for the brain to watch video content instead of reading. Reading builds focus and imagination, and is the best way to get deep learning. Avoid it, and watch your brain turn to reel-watching mush. Like anything else that is good for you, you have to build a practice around reading, just like going to the gym.

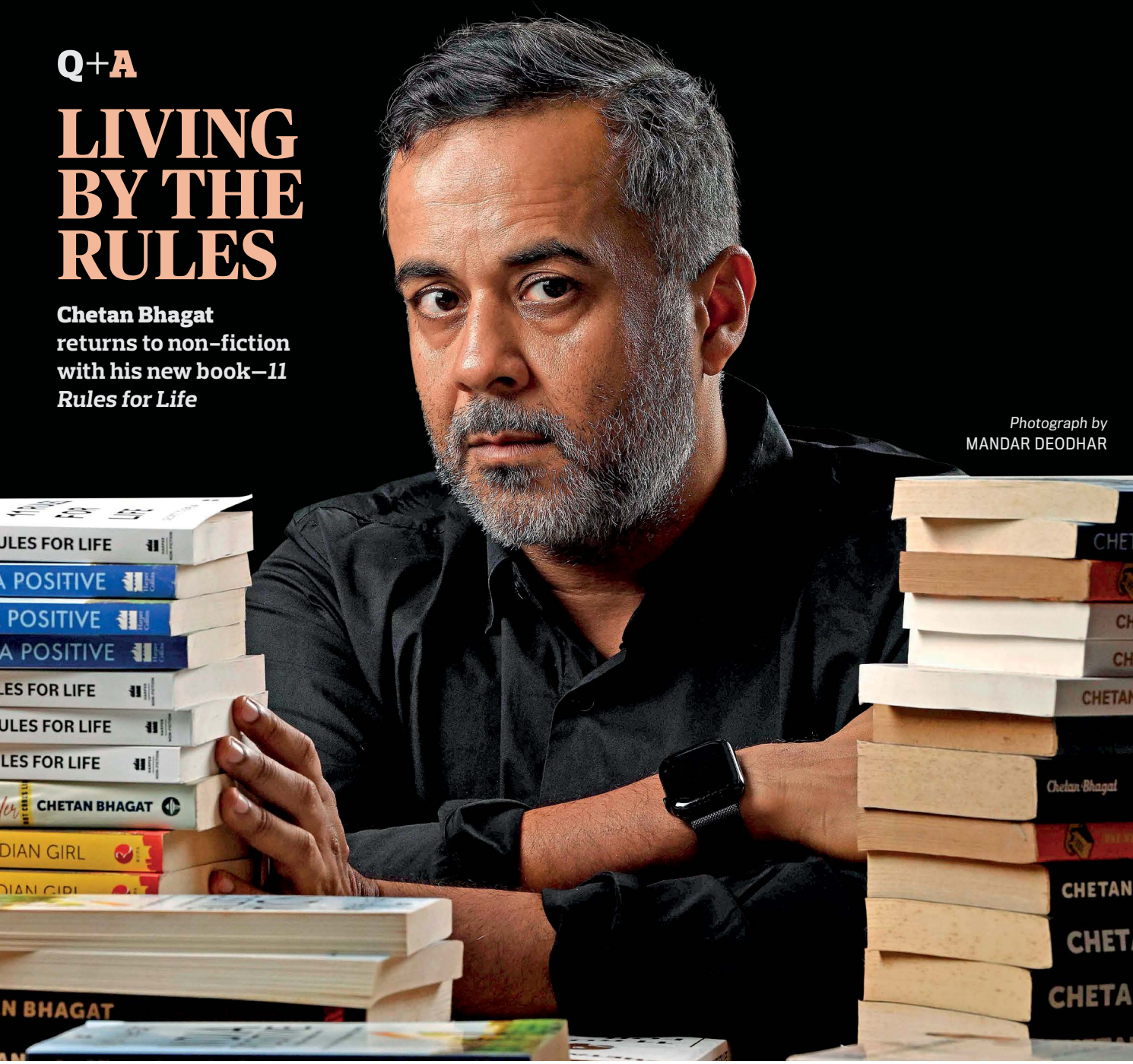
Q. What else are you working on right now?
I am thinking about a love story, with a lot of depth this time. After a self-help book, maybe my readers would like a return to a love story and that is what my heart wants to write as well. *11 Rules for Life* has also led to a lot of engagements as a motivational speaker.

–with Amit Dixit

Q+A

LIVING BY THE RULES

Chetan Bhagat returns to non-fiction with his new book—*11 Rules for Life*



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